

Investigation Report

Incident	inc-9a2b66db45
Service	payment-api
Status	CLOSED
Severity	HIGH
Root cause	Upstream dependency failure, most likely payment_gateway, with secondary latency impact on /payments/authorize and /payments/capture.
Confidence	0.85
Remediation status	CLOSED
LLM provider	codex
MCP investigation	True
MCP tools used	splunk_run_query
MCP log events	50
SPL queries used	None

AI Summary

Telemetry supports an upstream dependency outage or degradation as the primary driver of the incident. The service shows elevated latency and repeated upstream_api_failure errors while host CPU, memory, and DB pool usage remain below saturation, making an internal capacity issue less likely. The incident is consistent with dependency-sensitive request paths failing or retrying excessively. Reasoning: this summary interprets the evidence rather than repeating it. MCP supplied 50 correlated events; the RCA confidence is 0.85, so the recommended operator path is: Fail over or route around the degraded upstream dependency if an alternate is available.; Open a provider escalation for payment_gateway and verify identity_provider health if authorization paths are affected.; Throttle or cap retries to reduce amplification while the dependency is unstable..

Evidence Summary

50 events for payment-api across payment-01 and payment-02 show dominant upstream_api_failure and latency_regression signals. Affected endpoints are /payments/authorize and /payments/capture. Latency peaked at 4055 ms with average 1268.58 ms. Resource pressure was moderate: max CPU 81.31%, max memory 84.12%, max DB pool 74.46%. Multiple events reference payment_gateway, identity_provider, postgres, and redis, but the strongest failure pattern is upstream dependency-related rather than a pure host/resource issue.

MCP Evidence Summary

MCP client call: MCP evidence for payment-api: 50 events; errors=latency_regression, upstream_api_failure; hosts=payment-01, payment-02; endpoints=/payments/authorize, /payments/capture; dependencies=identity_provider, none, payment_gateway, postgres; avg_latency_ms=1269; max_latency_ms=4055; max_cpu_pct=81; max_db_pool_pct=74.

Recommended actions

- Fail over or route around the degraded upstream dependency if an alternate is available.
- Open a provider escalation for payment_gateway and verify identity_provider health if authorization paths are affected.
- Throttle or cap retries to reduce amplification while the dependency is unstable.
- Check recent dependency error rates, timeouts, and 5xx responses for payment_gateway, identity_provider, postgres, and redis.
- Validate whether deployment version 2026.06.1 correlates with the spike, but treat dependency failure as the primary hypothesis.

Safe remediation actions

- SIMULATE: Fail over upstream dependency
- SIMULATE: Open provider escalation
- SIMULATE: Throttle retries
- SIMULATE: Reduce retry budget and timeout aggressiveness
- SIMULATE: Route traffic away from affected endpoints if a fallback path exists

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